SPELL THE HIDDEN SCHWA

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

Each word below has a schwa where the box is. Say the clue word out loud with the stress shown underneath it. The stressed syllable tells you which vowel letter to write. Write the letter in the box, then write the whole word on the line.

How it works. In **definite** the second vowel is a schwa, so your ear gives you nothing: DEF-uh-nit. Now say the related word **definition**: the stress moves onto that syllable and the vowel wakes up, def-**i**-NI-tion. You can hear it is an i, so definite is spelled with an i. One word in a family stresses the syllable the other one swallows.

1.	def ☐ nite	clue word: **definition** say it: def-i-NI-tion	write the word _____
2.	rel ☐ tive	clue word: **relate** say it: re-LATE	write the word _____
3.	comp ☐ tition	clue word: **compete** say it: com-PETE	write the word _____
4.	met ☐ l	clue word: **metallic** say it: me-TAL-lic	write the word _____
5.	conf ☐ dence	clue word: **confide** say it: con-FIDE	write the word _____
6.	narr ☐ tive	clue word: **narrate** say it: nar-RATE	write the word _____
7.	inv ☐ tation	clue word: **invite** say it: in-VITE	write the word _____
8.	fant ☐ sy	clue word: **fantastic** say it: fan-TAS-tic	write the word _____
9.	hospit ☐ l	clue word: **hospitality** say it: hos-pi-TAL-i-ty	write the word _____
10.	leg ☐ l	clue word: **legality** say it: le-GAL-i-ty	write the word _____

No clue word? Words like pencil, circus and lesson have no helpful relative, so use the careful spelling voice instead and learn them by looking.

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SPELL THE HIDDEN SCHWA ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... Date: .....

Each word below has a schwa where the box is. Say the clue word out loud with the stress shown underneath it. The stressed syllable tells you which vowel letter to write. Write the letter in the box, then write the whole word on the line.

How it works. In **definite** the second vowel is a schwa, so your ear gives you nothing: DEF-uh-nit. Now say the related word **definition**: the stress moves onto that syllable and the vowel wakes up, def-**i**-NI-tion. You can hear it is an i, so definite is spelled with an i. One word in a family stresses the syllable the other one swallows.

1.	def**i**nite	clue word: **definition** say it: def-i-NI-tion	write the word	**definite**
2.	rel**a**tive	clue word: **relate** say it: re-LATE	write the word	**relative**
3.	comp**e**tition	clue word: **compete** say it: com-PETE	write the word	**competition**
4.	met**a**l	clue word: **metallic** say it: me-TAL-lic	write the word	**metal**
5.	confi**d**ence	clue word: **confide** say it: con-FIDE	write the word	**confidence**
6.	narr**a**tive	clue word: **narrate** say it: nar-RATE	write the word	**narrative**
7.	inv**i**tation	clue word: **invite** say it: in-VITE	write the word	**invitation**
8.	fant**a**sy	clue word: **fantastic** say it: fan-TAS-tic	write the word	**fantasy**
9.	hospit**a**l	clue word: **hospitality** say it: hos-pi-TAL-i-ty	write the word	**hospital**
10.	leg**a**l	clue word: **legality** say it: le-GAL-i-ty	write the word	**legal**

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